taken seriously. Tihar is a different world today. In it Bedi's charges are being imbued with positive attitudes and practical skills for life beyond the walls.

In all of Bedi's innovations there is a pattern: each one seeks to break down adversarial relations between the police and the community, and each one seeks to replace the hard hand of punishment with the healing hand of rehabilitation.

The discipline, confidence and competitive spirit of Bedi's youth remain with her at age forty-five. She is impatient and inclined to buck the system. 'It is tough to go against the wave,' she says, 'but at least you reach where nobody else can.'

In electing Kiran Bedi to receive the 1994 Ramon Magsaysay Award for Government Service, the Board of Trustees recognizes her building confidence in India's police through dynamic leadership and effective innovations in crime control, drug rehabilitation, and humane prison reform.

The Acceptance Speech

Mr President, Mrs Magsaysay, trustees, ladies and gentlemen:

Twenty-two years ago when I decided to join the elite Indian Police Service, I saw in it great potential for the 'Power to Do', the 'Power to Get Things Done', and the 'Power to Correct'. I do firmly believe that police in any country can be the greatest protector of human rights and the rule of law – as it could as well be the greatest violator of both.

The Ramon Magsaysay Award has done a couple of magical things in my case, as it does in others:

(i) It has recognized the 'Power to Prevent'

Crime prevention is usually given a lower priority and underestimated as an area of policing. What gets priority and headlines is detections and seizures, and not prevention of delinquency and breach of peace, which had all the potential of violent crime.

(ii) The Power of Policing with People

'Policing is for People', therefore, people must be made partners in policing. Once that is done in a variety of ways, it provides transparency and accountability to the whole system. Resources which cannot alone come from police could come from participative policing.

(iii) The Power of the Team

Leaders in police or government, if they want results, need to form teams, and allow them initiatives, delegation, support, non-interference and training with total emphasis on professional integrity. While personal example is crucial, sharing of achievements will lead to more results. This will lead to not only 'Keeping Security' but 'Creating Security'.

The Award has propelled me to consolidate and expand my work. For this I have registered a Trust, called India Vision, that I am breathing life into at this moment. I will carry forward projects in the fields of Prison Reform, Drug Abuse Prevention, Empowerment of Women, Mental Disability and Sports Promotion. I seek your greater support in these projects.

I accept the Ramon Magsaysay Award with total gratitude to the Foundation and the Philippines, on behalf of my team comprising Police-Prison-People and my family from India.

Just before leaving for [this] ceremony, I received a call from my Prison Headquarters (from my DIG, Mr Sarangi) that at this very time all my 9500 prisoners are having special celebrations within the prison premises.